Human-made Things in the Bible © United Bible Societies, 2025. Adapted from: The Works of Their Hands: Man-made Things in the Bible, by Ray Pritz © 2009 United Bible Societies. This work is licensed under Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0/).

Deck

8.1.11 Deck

References:

Hebrew תַּחְתִּי (tachti) GEN 6:16

Hebrew קֶרֶשׁ (qeresh) EZK 27:6

Greek σανίδωμα (sanidōma) 3MA 4:10

Description:

(Image generated by ChatGPT using OpenAI technology)The deck was a platform extending from one side of a ship to the other side. Larger ships could have more than one deck at different levels. The ark described in GEN 6:0 had three decks.

Translation:

A “deck” in a ship is equivalent to a “floor” in a building, and some translations of GEN 6:16 use “stories” (CEV). GECL expands the last clause of this verse, saying “put in two middle decks, so that it is three floors high.” The three decks of the large ship built by Noah were evidently all inside the ship, because the whole structure was roofed, unlike a normal ancient ship.

Chariot: See 2.15 Chariot<REALIA:2.15>.